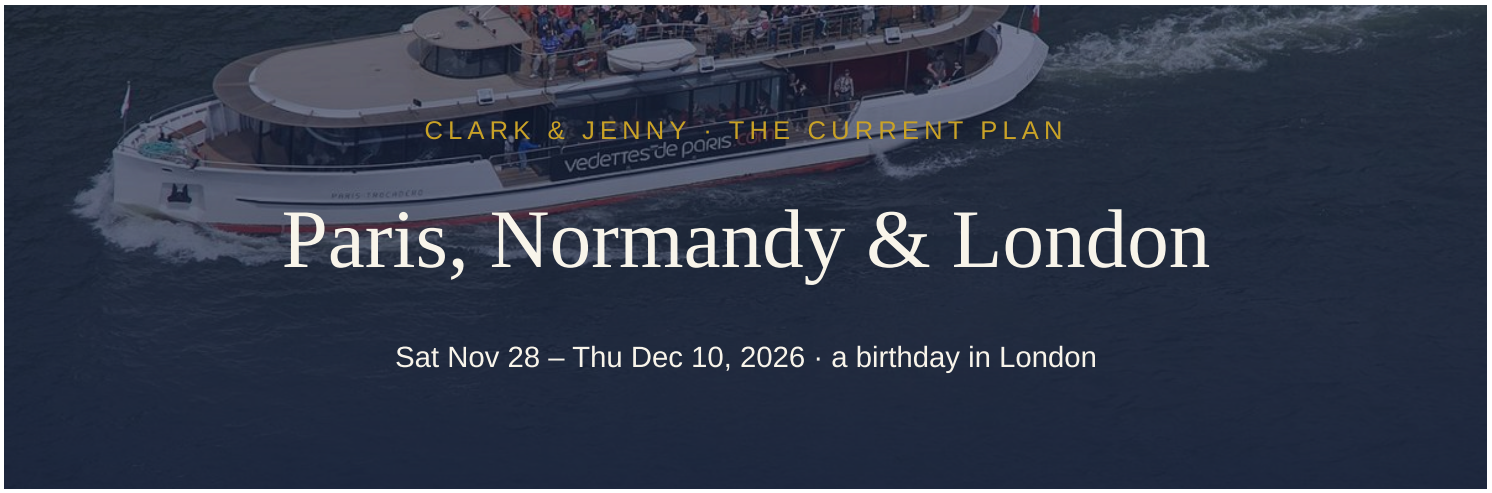


CLARK & JENNY · THE CURRENT PLAN

Paris, Normandy & London

Sat Nov 28 – Thu Dec 10, 2026 · a birthday in London

Legend: BOOKED locked in OPEN not booked yet, still changeable ALTERNATE not chosen yet. Every line carries one. Summary in Booked & Open.

The Paris week is unchanged. Then five extra days: a night facing Mont-Saint-Michel, the D-Day coast and an evening ferry to a night in Portsmouth (or the alternate via Paris), and three nights in London with the birthday dinner on Mon Dec 7. Same rhythm: slow mornings, one light anchor a day, one proper dinner.

Weather: Normandy and London in December are cool, grey and damp, highs around 45–48 °F, windy on the coast; sunset ~4:55 PM in Normandy and ~3:50 PM in London. Pack layers, a waterproof jacket and good shoes.

BOOKED **Flights (United Polaris via Chicago):** Out Sat Nov 28: UA5867 Traverse City 2:18 PM → O'Hare 2:55 PM, then UA987 O'Hare 6:45 PM → Paris CDG 9:55 AM Nov 29. Home Thu Dec 10 (open-jaw from London Heathrow T2): UA928 1:35 PM → O'Hare 4:55 PM (seats 4D/5F), then UA2304 O'Hare 7:45 PM → Traverse City 9:59 PM (First, 2E/2F).

DAY 0

Sat Nov 28 · Travel day

Anchor: Get to Paris rested.



Morning OPEN	Pack, and a relaxed early afternoon departure from home.
Afternoon BOOKED	**UA5867** 2:18 PM → O'Hare 2:55 PM (seats 2C/2D), short hop from Traverse City (TVC) to Chicago O'Hare on United. Time in the United Polaris lounge: sit-down dinner, shower suite, quiet room.
Evening BOOKED	Overnight United Polaris flight Chicago → Paris CDG. Dinner was in the lounge, so sleep early. **UA987** O'Hare 6:45 PM → Paris CDG 9:55 AM Sun Nov 29 (seats 3D/3F).

DAY 1

Sun Nov 29 · Arrive and settle

Anchor: None. Land, rest, tub.



Morning OPEN	Land at CDG Terminal 1 mid-morning. Pre-booked car to the hotel (hotel car or Welcome Pickups). Drop bags at Hôtel Le Cinq Codet around noon.
Afternoon OPEN Le Cinq Codet booked; activities open	Latte at Noir – Rue de Grenelle, pastry from La Parisienne. Check in at 3 PM, nap and the tub. Optional wander down Rue Cler.
Evening OPEN	Dusk walk to the Champ de Mars (sunset ~4:57 PM; the Tower sparkles on the hour). 7:30 PM dinner at Bistrot des Fables. Jenny: salmon with sorrel or sea bream. Dessert: bourbon-vanilla crème brûlée.

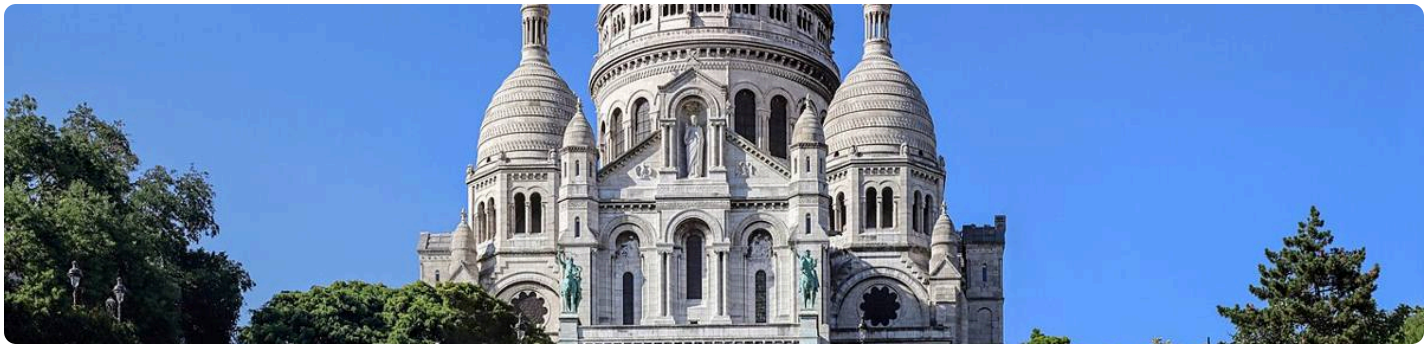
DAY 2

Mon Nov 30 · Montmartre at sunset + Moulin Rouge

Anchor: One evening outing.



Morning OPEN	Late start. Latte at Dialogues Coffee, then tub and rest.
Afternoon OPEN	1 PM lunch at Les Cocottes (Jenny: roast cod). ~3:15 taxi to Montmartre; dress smart for tonight. Ride the funicular up to Sacré-Cœur.
Evening OPEN	Sunset from the basilica steps (~4:56 PM), stroll Place du Tertre. **Moulin Rouge Dinner & Show**: doors 6:45, dinner with the orchestra at 7 PM, Féerie show at 9 PM. Jenny: the **Belle Époque menu** (smoked salmon, then pike-perch) — flag the shellfish allergy when booking. Smart dress, no trainers. Taxi home ~11 PM. Book only via reservations.moulinrouge.fr.



Sacré-Cœur, Montmartre

DAY 3

Tue Dec 1 · Catacombs + lunch at Baguette

Anchor: The Catacombs, then a long lunch.



Morning **OPEN**	~9:15 filter coffee at Coutume. Metro line 6 to Denfert-Rochereau. 10:30 timed entry at the Catacombes de Paris (~1 hr, 131 steps down / 112 up, ~14 °C inside — bring a layer, no big bags).
Afternoon **OPEN**	Taxi to Montorgueil. 12:15 lunch at Baguette, French-Asian small plates. Jenny: salmon tartare with ginger, truffle risotto, smoked aubergine — skip the shrimp spring roll. Dessert: black-sesame crème brûlée. Keep it light. Taxi back, rest and tub.
Evening **OPEN**	7:30 PM dinner at Café Caillou. Jenny: fresh salmon, mushroom risotto or aubergine gratin. Clark: a Chinon by the bottle.



The Montorgueil quarter, home of Baguette

DAY 4

Wed Dec 2 · Versailles + Gordon Ramsay au Trianon

Anchor: The palace, then the starred dinner. Long day; taxi home.



Morning OPEN	~9:15 pastry; dress smart casual for dinner. ~9:45 RER C from Champ de Mars–Tour Eiffel to Versailles Château Rive Gauche (~35–40 min). 11:00 timed entry, Palace of Versailles (Passport ticket).
Afternoon OPEN	~1 PM lunch at Ore – Ducasse in the palace grounds. Jenny: truite aux amandes; skip the raw scallops. ~2:30 gardens, then the Trianons and Marie-Antoinette's Hamlet (last entry 4:45).
Evening OPEN	~5 PM drinks at the Waldorf Astoria Trianon Palace bar: an Old Fashioned for Clark, Crémant for Jenny. 7:30 PM Gordon Ramsay au Trianon ★ — request a pescatarian, shellfish-free menu at booking (signatures use lobster and cockles). ~10:15 pre-booked taxi back to the hotel: **the RER C closes evenings from 11 PM for works**.



Trianon Palace, home of Gordon Ramsay au Trianon

DAY 5

Thu Dec 3 · The big-view day

Anchor: The 5 PM Seine cruise.



Morning OPEN	~10:00 slow coffee at Dialogues. Optional walk over Pont d'Iéna to the Trocadéro esplanade for the classic Tower view.
Afternoon OPEN	1 PM light lunch at Les Cocottes. Tub and rest. Leave 4:35, dressed warm.
Evening OPEN	5 PM cruise with Bateaux Parisiens (Port de la Bourdonnais), back ~6 PM as the Tower sparkles. Old Fashioned at Minuit Express. ~7:45 dinner at Le Bosquet (Jenny: grilled cod, sauce vierge — oysters on the menu, flag the allergy).

DAY 6

Fri Dec 4 · Super-relaxed last day

Anchor: None. Early night.



Morning **OPEN**	Late breakfast from La Parisienne, latte at Noir, last stroll down Rue Cler.
Afternoon **OPEN**	Light lunch at Les Cocottes. Hotel spa and a long soak. Pack; confirm the morning car.
Evening **OPEN**	7 PM farewell dinner at La Fontaine de Mars. Jenny: salmon in salt crust or roasted sea bass. Dessert: crème brûlée à la vanille. Lights out ~10.

DAY 7

Sat Dec 5 · Paris → Mont-Saint-Michel

Anchor: Arrive at the Mont by sunset.



Morning **OPEN** Le Cinq Codet checkout booked; TGV open	Slow breakfast and check out of Le Cinq Codet (~10:00). Taxi to Paris-Montparnasse. **TGV INOUI 8615** Montparnasse 10:57 AM → Rennes 12:25 PM, direct (SNCF Connect timetable; times from the current timetable, confirm when December sales open). Earlier backup: TGV 8609, 10:00 → 11:25.
Afternoon **OPEN**	Lunch at Rennes station, then pick up a premium sedan or SUV at SIXT Rennes station (one-way, returned in Caen on Sunday). Easy, toll-free drive to the Mont (~1 hr 15), arriving ~2:45 PM. No-car fallback: the Keolis Rennes → Mont-Saint-Michel bus, timed to the Paris TGVs. Check in at the Dec 5 hotel: Jenny picks Option A or B (see below).
Evening **OPEN**	Sunset (~4:55 PM) over the bay, then and a quiet walk up the lit, empty village. Dinner at your hotel (both have a restaurant). Jenny: local fish of the day; Normandy is shellfish country, so flag the allergy every time.

Sat Dec 5 hotel: two options for Jenny **OPEN**

Option A: outside the walls	Option B: inside the walls
Le Relais Saint-Michel (Signature room, Mount view), on the mainland causeway. About €319/night (approx. estimate; source: earlier flexible quote).	Les Terrasses Poulard on the Grande Rue: bay-view double, ask for the upper L'Ermitage annex. About €280–450/night (approx. estimate; source:

	guidebook). Alternative inside the walls: La Mère Poulard (no price found).
Luggage: park at the door, no steps. Easiest by far.	**Luggage:** park on the mainland, shuttle, then walk up cobbles and steps; the annex is reached by steps and terraced gardens. Pack a small overnight bag and leave the big cases in the car.
Evening: calm, but you take the free shuttle across to walk the lit village.	**Evening:** the magic one. Day-trippers leave, and you have the lit, empty streets and ramparts to yourselves.
View: the whole lit Mont from your window, the classic postcard.	**View:** bay views from the upper rooms; you are inside the picture, not looking at it.
Dinner: hotel restaurant facing the Mont (nightly 7–9:30 PM). **Morning:** shuttle back for the 9:30 abbey.	**Dinner:** La Mère Poulard's famous omelette next door, or a Grande Rue brasserie; fish for Jenny, flag the shellfish allergy. **Morning:** abbey is a few minutes uphill.

DAY 8

Sun Dec 6 · Abbey, D-Day coast, then the evening ferry

Anchor: Abbey at opening, the American Cemetery, and the 4:30 PM sailing to England.



Morning OPEN	Breakfast with the view. 9:30 AM opening at the Mont-Saint-Michel Abbey (~45 min; dress warm). Check out and leave the Mont at ~10:30.
Afternoon OPEN	Drive ~1 hr 50 on the A84 to the Normandy American Cemetery above Omaha Beach; picnic or café lunch, about 1 hr 15 there (~12:15–1:30). Drive ~50 min to Caen station and drop the car by ~2:30 (confirm Sunday key drop with SIXT), then a 20-min taxi to the Ouistreham ferry port, arriving ~3:00. Foot-passenger check-in closes at 3:30.
Evening OPEN	**Brittany Ferries** Caen-Ouistreham 4:30 PM → Portsmouth 9:30 PM UK time (~6 hrs; the 4:30 sailing runs every day of the year). Book a cabin to nap, plus dinner on board (Jenny: fish, flag the shellfish allergy). Disembarking takes ~30 min, then a 5-min taxi to The Ship Leopard on The Hard (recommended, open; fallback the Royal Maritime Hotel, check-in until 1 AM). Straight to bed. *If the ferry is cancelled:* the next sailing is the 11:30 PM overnight from Caen (cabin, arrives about 6:15 AM), or take the train Caen → Paris (~2 hr) and the Eurostar on Dec 7 (see the alternate plan below).

DAY 9

Mon Dec 7 · Birthday · Portsmouth → London

Anchor: A slow morning and lunchtime arrival in London, then the birthday dinner.



Morning OPEN	Breakfast at the hotel, then a short stroll on The Hard past HMS Warrior to the station. **South Western Railway** direct train Portsmouth Harbour 10:15 AM → London Waterloo 11:51 AM (per SWR's Sep 2026 timetable; trains about every 30 min if you want to linger).
Afternoon BOOKED	Taxi from Waterloo to W London at 10 Wardour Street, Leicester Square (~15 min), arriving ~12:15 PM. Booked: Standard King; birthday noted and an upgrade requested. Check-in is 3 PM, so drop bags and have lunch in Soho or Chinatown (a 2–5 min walk), then rest. Leicester Square and Piccadilly Circus Tube stations are each ~3 min away. Time to dress for dinner.
Evening BOOKED	Birthday dinner at Gymkhana, the Michelin-starred Indian at 42 Albemarle Street, Mayfair, **9:15 PM** (we asked for an earlier table; it moves if they offer one). ~12–15 min walk from the hotel via Piccadilly Circus, or a 5-min taxi. Smart casual. Jenny's pescatarian diet and shellfish allergy and the birthday are noted for the restaurant. Old Fashioned first at the W Lounge; Champagne or English sparkling for Jenny.

DAY 10

Tue Dec 8 · Churchill War Rooms + Christmas at Kew

Anchor: A morning museum, then the lights at Kew.



Morning OPEN	Slow morning. ~11 AM timed entry to the Churchill War Rooms (~1 hr 30; taxi ~15 min). Alternative: the Tower of London and the Crown Jewels. The Bayeux Tapestry at the British Museum (~15 min walk from the hotel) is sold out; worth checking for returns.
Afternoon OPEN	Lunch near Westminster, then back to the hotel to rest.
Evening OPEN	Taxi (~45 min) to Christmas at Kew for an early-evening timed entry, the illuminated trail through the gardens (~1 hr 30, dress warm). Taxi back and a relaxed late dinner.

DAY 11

Wed Dec 9 · London at Christmas

Anchor: Tower Bridge and a riverside lunch, then Winter Wonderland at dusk.



Morning OPEN	Late breakfast. ~10:30 AM taxi or Tube (~20 min) to the Tower Bridge Exhibition: the high-level walkways with the glass floor over the Thames, and the Victorian engine rooms (~1 hr 15; tickets not booked yet, buy online in advance).
Afternoon OPEN	~12:30 PM lunch at Coppa Club Tower Bridge, on the north bank just west of the bridge (Three Quays Walk, next to the Tower of London), with terrace views of Tower Bridge and The Shard. Open from 9 AM (Mon–Thu until 11 PM); lunch bowls and the all-day menu from 11:30 AM. The heated riverside igloos must be booked ahead (not booked yet). Jenny: check the menu for fish and vegetarian dishes and flag the shellfish allergy. Then back to the hotel to rest and pack.
Evening OPEN	Stroll into Hyde Park Winter Wonderland after dark (open Nov 19 – Jan 3). Farewell dinner; early night.

DAY 12

Thu Dec 10 · Fly home from Heathrow

Anchor: A relaxed last morning, then Polaris home.



Morning OPEN W London booked; transfer open	Late breakfast and a slow pack. Leave the hotel at ~10:15 AM: 3-min walk to Leicester Square and the Piccadilly line direct to Heathrow Terminals 2 & 3 (~50 min), or a 10-min walk to Tottenham Court Road and the Elizabeth line (~35 min), arriving ~11:15 for the 1:35 PM flight. With bags, a taxi (~1 hr) is the easy alternative.
Afternoon BOOKED	**UA928** Heathrow T2 1:35 PM → Chicago O'Hare 4:55 PM, United Polaris (Boeing 767-300). Seats: Clark 4D, Jenny 5F (center seats, one diagonally behind the other).
Evening BOOKED	2h50 connection at O'Hare: clear passport control and customs, re-check bags and re-screen, then a sit-down dinner in the United Polaris lounge (Terminal 1, near gate C18). **UA2304** O'Hare 7:45 PM → Traverse City 9:59 PM, First, seats 2E/2F.

ALTERNATE – NOT CHOSEN YET

Alternate plan, Sun Dec 6 – Mon Dec 7: via Paris

Clark and Jenny still deciding; the ferry plan stays primary.

Sun Dec 6	Abbey at 9:30 as planned, then drive Mont-Saint-Michel → Paris (~4 hr; one-way rental fee applies; drop the car in Paris). One night in Paris (hotel to be chosen).
Mon Dec 7	Late-morning Eurostar from Paris Gare du Nord (e.g. ~11:13 AM, ~2h20; check in 45–60 min before; exact times to be confirmed), arriving London St Pancras ~12:30–1 PM, then taxi to the W London.
Replaces	The Ouistreham ferry, the Caen car drop and the Portsmouth night. Why: it does not depend on Channel weather.

Booked (locked in)

Item	What
BOOKED **Flights out, Sat Nov 28**	UA5867 Traverse City 2:18 PM → O'Hare 2:55 PM (2C/2D); UA987 O'Hare 6:45 PM → Paris CDG 9:55 AM Nov 29 (3D/3F).
BOOKED **Paris hotel, Nov 29 – Dec 5**	Le Cinq Codet, 7th arrondissement.
BOOKED **London hotel, Dec 7 – 10**	W London, 10 Wardour Street, Leicester Square, London W1D 6QF, Standard King (birthday noted, upgrade requested).
BOOKED **Birthday dinner, Mon Dec 7**	Gymkhana, 42 Albemarle St, Mayfair, 9:15 PM (asked for earlier). Smart casual.
BOOKED **Flights home, Thu Dec 10**	UA928 Heathrow T2 1:35 PM → O'Hare 4:55 PM (4D/5F); UA2304 O'Hare 7:45 PM → Traverse City 9:59 PM (First, 2E/2F).

Open (not booked yet, still changeable)

Item	What
OPEN **Mont-Saint-Michel hotel, Sat Dec 5**	Option A: Le Relais Saint-Michel (outside, Mount view) or Option B: Les Terrasses Poulard (inside the walls; alt La Mère Poulard). Jenny picks; see Dec 5.

OPEN **Portsmouth hotel, Sun Dec 6**	Recommended: The Ship Leopard Boutique Hotel on The Hard (~2 min from Portsmouth Harbour station, adults only, harbour-view King), from about £132/night (approx. estimate; source: Tripadvisor “from” price). Fallback: Royal Maritime Hotel (check-in until 1 AM; no price found).
OPEN **Rental car**	SIXT automatic estate or SUV with room for luggage, Rennes station Sat Dec 5 → Caen station Sun Dec 6, mid-afternoon drop (one-way, same country).
OPEN **TGV, Sat Dec 5**	TGV 8615 Paris-Montparnasse 10:57 AM → Rennes 12:25 PM.
OPEN **Ferry, Sun Dec 6**	Brittany Ferries Caen-Ouistreham 4:30 PM → Portsmouth 9:30 PM (foot passengers, cabin).
OPEN **Train, Mon Dec 7**	SWR Portsmouth Harbour 10:15 AM → London Waterloo 11:51 AM (SWR Sep 2026 timetable); trains about every 30 min as backup.
OPEN **Tower Bridge + Coppa Club, Wed Dec 9**	Tower Bridge Exhibition tickets (late morning), then lunch at Coppa Club Tower Bridge ~12:30 PM;

	book an igloo ahead if you want one.
OPEN **Paris activities and dinners**	Moulin Rouge (decision due Sun Nov 1), Catacombs, Versailles, the Seine cruise and the Paris dinner tables.
OPEN **Airport transfers**	CDG → hotel Nov 29; hotel → Heathrow Dec 10 (Tube or taxi on the day).
OPEN **Alternate: via Paris (Dec 6–7)**	ALTERNATE – NOT CHOSEN YET Drive to Paris, one night there, Eurostar Dec 7. Replaces the ferry, Caen drop and Portsmouth night; see the alternate box.
OPEN **London sights**	Churchill War Rooms or Tower of London, Christmas at Kew (Tue Dec 8), Tower Bridge Exhibition and Winter Wonderland (Wed Dec 9). Bayeux Tapestry at the British Museum is sold out (check for returns).

Dining notes

Jenny: pescatarian, shellfish allergy

> **Je suis allergique aux fruits de mer et crustacés. Je mange du poisson mais pas de fruits de mer.**
> *In London: "Pescatarian, with a shellfish allergy — no prawns, crab, lobster, scallops, mussels or oysters, and no shellfish stock."*

Normandy menus lean on oysters, mussels and scallops; ask for the fish of the day (sole, bar, cabillaud, saumon). Jenny: Crémant or Champagne in France, English sparkling in London. Clark: bold reds, an Old Fashioned at the hotel bar, crème brûlée when it appears.

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